

MOVIE

Solo

★★★★☆ | Solo is the second anthology Star Wars film. We get to see in action the backstory of Han Solo (Alden Ehrenreich), how he met Chewie (Joonas Suotamo), the game of sabacc with Lando (Donald Glover), and even the legendary Kessel run. It is just a series of fast paced cinematic fodder: Chase sequence, war scene, hand to hand combat, train heist and so on. For a film full of action, it managed to have a heart too, and showed that the galaxy does not revolve around the Skywalker family. Solo is the first Star Wars movie where not a single Skywalker shows up. The villain, Enfys Nest and the gang of Cloud Riders start a chain of events that have a huge impact in the future of the galaxy. Dryden Vos (Paul Bettany), Qi'ra (Emilia Clarke) and Tobias Beckett (Woody Harrelson) are all ruthless criminals with various levels of involvement in a crime syndicate, the Crimson Dawn. Solo is a scoundrel with a heart of gold, surrounded by sharks on all sides. His only real friend is Chewie, and they take on the intrigue and subterfuge together. The droids just kept getting better in the series, with L3-37 having more attitude than even K-2SO did in Rogue One. L3-37 steals the show every time she is on screen. Unfortunately, Solo released at a time when both Deadpool 2 and Avengers: Infinity War were still in theatres. To further complicate matters, the Star Wars community has become even more entrenched in toxicity, with a backlash against the new directions in which Disney is taking the franchise. Disney actually had to clarify to a fan that Phasma did not need to have "feminine" armour. Solo might not have performed well in the box office, but we still give this movie a solid four stars.



TV SHOW

The Expanse S3

★★★★☆ | If you haven't been following The Expanse over season 1 and 2, go watch them and come back here. Season 3 starts off with the Solar System on the brink of war. Tensions have escalated between Earth and Mars, as Mars blames Earth for the assassination of defence minister Korshunov and everybody wants a piece of whatever is happening with the protomolecule on Venus. But even at a character level, we see a lot of interesting changes as Naomi actions distance her from the rest of the Rocinante crew, Holden finally cracks under the weight of everything that is going on.

In all of this, you get the hint of a deeper, convoluted objective that the protomolecule is trying to fulfil through visions of Miller that Holden starts seeing right as the protomolecule decides to get up and going at building a giant structure in the middle of the Solar System, which everyone decides to have a claim on. Yep, that's classic Expanse for you.

The season maintains the series' brilliant focus on getting its science and technology right, with just the perfect mix of politics, intrigue, suspense and action – enough to keep you on your toes without alienating the geeky bits. If you aren't already hooked on to it, you're essentially missing out on Game of Thrones in space.



UP AND COMING

MOVIE

The Equalizer 2



Denzel Washington's 2014 action thriller The Equalizer was quite good. Good enough to warrant us being somewhat

excited about the sequel. We do have some concerns about the plot though.

Release date: July 19, 2018

MOVIE

Skyscraper



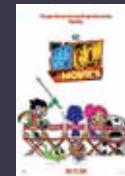
Starring Dwayne "The Rock" Johnson, who seems to be in just about every movie these days, Skyscraper is an

action-thriller, just the kind of movie for The Rock. This one's got some high (literally) octane action.

Release date: July 12, 2018

MOVIE

Teen Titans GO to the Movies



We weren't (still aren't) too happy about the super cartoony reboot the Teen Titans got in their new series, but the movie trailer had us hyped about it anyway. We don't want to give this one a miss.

Release date: 27 July, 2018